

Jack Hessefort

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EDUCATION

University of South Florida — Tampa, FL

May 2026

Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity, Bellini College of Artificial Intelligence, Cybersecurity and Computing — Summa Cum Laude, GPA: 3.93

PROJECTS

SOC Detection Lab — Wazuh SIEM + AD + Kali Attack Simulation github.com/meet246/SOC-Detection-Lab

- Deployed Wazuh v4.14.7 SIEM on Ubuntu Server, integrating DC and Windows 11 client agents enhanced with Sysmon v15.21 telemetry across an enterprise Active Directory environment.
- Authored two custom behavioral detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK: Office application spawning a shell (T1204.002/T1059.001) and PsExec-style lateral movement via Windows root service installation (T1021.002/T1569.002).
- Simulated PsExec lateral movement from Kali using Impacket, achieving a remote SYSTEM shell; iterated rule logic from IOC-based to TTP-based (binary path pattern) after initial rule failed against randomized service names — demonstrating behavioral vs. signature detection tradeoffs.
- Documented defense-in-depth: Windows Defender quarantined the payload while Wazuh independently detected the service installation event, confirming each layer operates independently.

SOC Analysis: PSEXEC Pivot (ReliaQuest Simulation) github.com/meet246/soc-analysis-psexec-pivot

- Investigated PSEXEC-based lateral movement within the GreyMatter SIEM, correlating authentication events, privilege escalation behavior, and endpoint telemetry to identify indicators of compromise.
- Documented technical incident response workflows in a formal analyst report — the same technique later replicated and detected in the home SOC lab above.

Enterprise Active Directory & Windows Security Lab github.com/meet246/Active-Directory-Enterprise-Lab

- Built a Windows Server 2022 AD DS/DNS/DHCP environment with domain-joined clients; automated user provisioning and security group management via PowerShell and CSV-driven onboarding workflows.
- Implemented GPOs to deploy login banners, centralized security configurations, and Wazuh agent startup scripts; hardened the environment by disabling LLMNR/NetBIOS and configuring advanced audit policies.

Network Forensics: HTTP Beaconing Analysis github.com/meet246/SOC-Investigation-HTTP-Beaconing

- Packet-level Wireshark forensic analysis identifying HTTP beaconing, reverse shell activity, and C2 communication; reconstructed attacker timelines via TCP stream analysis and HTTP request correlation.

EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Analyst Intern

Feb 2025 – Mar 2025

ReliaQuest Cybersecurity Labs

- Executed end-to-end incident response within the GreyMatter SIEM, investigating high-fidelity alerts including PSEXEC lateral movement and privilege escalation.
- Analyzed endpoint telemetry and network traffic to identify indicators of compromise (IOCs), using OSINT and internal threat intelligence to validate alerts.
- Documented technical workflows and remediation steps for simulated breaches following NIST-aligned incident response playbooks.

Customer Service and Operations

May 2023 – Aug 2025

Walmart, Dunkin', Dogatopia

- Delivered consistent, high-quality service across multiple customer-facing and operations roles in fast-paced, high-volume environments, demonstrating reliability and adaptability.

SKILLS

Security & SOC: SIEM Monitoring, Threat Detection, Incident Response, Log Analysis, IOC Analysis, Detection Engineering, Network Forensics, OSINT, NIST

Tools: Wazuh, GreyMatter SIEM, Sysmon, Wireshark, Nmap, Metasploit, Impacket, PowerShell

Systems & Networking: Active Directory, Windows Server, Linux (Ubuntu), TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, Group Policy, Network Traffic Analysis

IT Support & IAM: Troubleshooting, Account/Access Management, User Onboarding (AD), Technical Documentation, MFA, Least Privilege, RBAC, AWS (S3, IAM)

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ | CompTIA A+ | AWS Cloud Practitioner | Microsoft MTA: Windows Server Administration Fundamentals